Curriculum Vitae: Tips & Tricks

RCCG RKP CAREER & MENTORSHIP DAY

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Definitions

A **curriculum vitae (CV)**— Latin for "course of life"— is a detailed document that summarizes a person's education, work history, skills, and academic or professional achievements

*A **career** is the journey of a person's professional life, including the various roles, jobs, and experiences they pursue over time. **It's more than just a job**— **Career…job history, goals and attainments.** It reflects long-term goals achieved, personal growth, skill development, and contributions to a field or industry.*



When performed by an employee in an exchange for pay, a **job** consists of duties, responsibilities, and tasks **(performance elements)** that are (**1) defined and specific**, and (**2**) can be **accomplished, quantified, measured, and rated.**

The Hay Method…jobs evaluation (measurement and comparison)

- Developed by Edward Hay during the Second World War
- Provides a structured, predictive and reliable way of measuring and comparing jobs across different professions
- Is used by the oil majors in the world.

The contribution expected and the results

- Freedom to act
- Impact and extent of contribution



The knowledge & experience required to hold a job

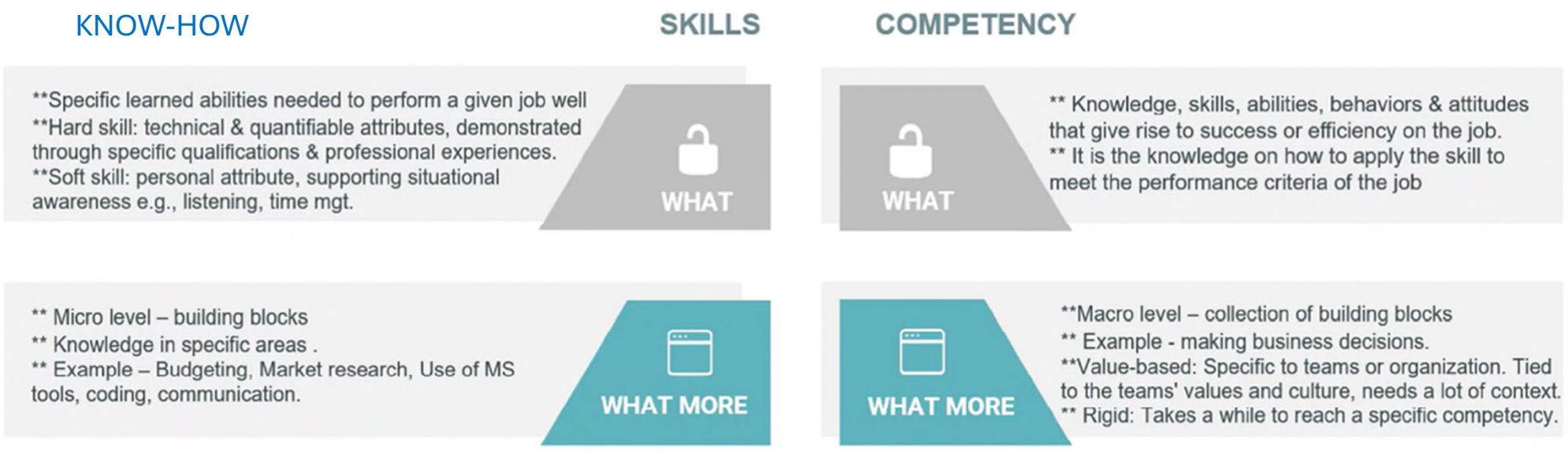
- Level of knowledge and experience
- Capacity to organise, coordinate and manage
- Human relations skill

The nature and complexity of the thinking necessary to resolve problems

- Thinking environment
- Thinking challenge

Job description... the basis for job placement & evaluation

ACCOUNTABILITY / OBJECTIVE	Example 1	Example 2
• WHAT IS REQUIRED (Verb)?	• Analyse	• Develop and recommend
• FOR WHAT (Object)?	• Sales data	• Sales and revenue budgets
• AND WHY (End-result - KRA)?	• To produce reports	• To meet planned growth
• TARGET (Objective -KPI)?	• On monthly basis by 5th day	• On annual basis by 1st January



Accountabilities, Know-hows and Achievements are CV's building blocks

Top Ten Most Wanted Core Skills

Qualification and skills are only part of what hiring managers care about. A job posting doesn't tell you everything employers want. They especially want to know you're a good fit for the job. What makes a good fit?



Technical skills
Skills needed to perform the Job



Self motivated
Taking responsibility for your work, not always told what to do. **This is particularly looked out for the higher you go up.**



Evolutionary Skills
You know how to learn, and how to continually improve. You can grow and evolve in your work



Effective Communication
Clear, concise and effective communicator



Problem Solving Skills
Make decisions, solve problems, Provide solutions to issues



Strength of character
Honest, Integrity, loyalty



Plan & organize your time
Set goals and reach them



Teamwork
You can work confidently within a group, You let your voice be heard and respect what others have to say.



Flexibility & Adaptability
Manage multiple assignments and tasks, set priorities, adapt to changing conditions, and work assignments



Good interpersonal skills
High emotional IQ, you know how to get along with others (relate across people & cultures with sensitivity and awareness), and minimize conflict

Make your skills transferable … Curriculum Vitae update

Why have a CV?

IT'S YOUR PROFESSIONAL CALLING CARD

THE PURPOSE OF A CV IS TO GET YOU AN INTERVIEW.



YOUR CV SHOULD GIVE MANAGERS AND INTERVIEWERS:

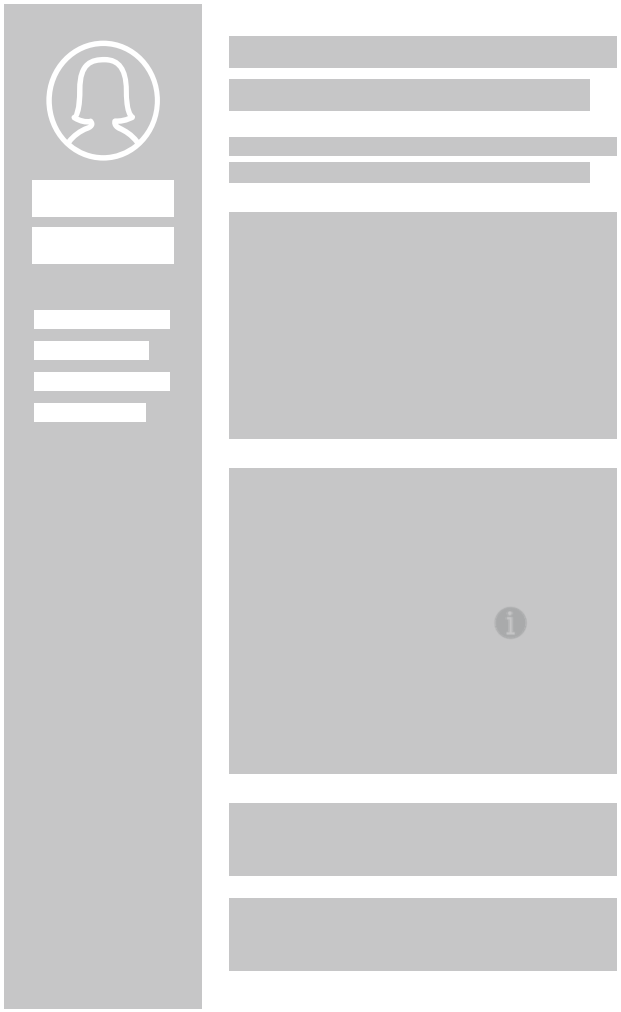
A clear overview of your profile and key qualifications.

A firm desire to meet you.

What are guidelines for a good CV?

- Don't overfill the space.
- Keep your sentences short.
- Use words that are simple but accurate.
- Watch out for spelling mistakes.
- Avoid using personal pronouns ("I", "we").
- Don't use abbreviations.
- Avoid technical jargon.
- Organize your CV into sections with coherent headings.
- Try to keep everything on one or two pages, at most.

The various sections of a CV



Name and Contact Info + (Optional) Photo

- First and last names.
- Contact information: phone number and email address.
- Job title relating to your current or desired position.
- Optional summary statement: one or two short, well-worded sentences.
- Optional photo: A portrait shot of you smiling, in professional attire.

Experience or Skills

- Chronological or functional (skills-based) format.
- Positions held, from most to least recent vs work history by topic or skill set
- Linear career path with same employer vs change of employer or industry
- No long periods of inactivity vs return after long periods of inactivity

Education

- Degrees obtained.
- Additional training that relates to your professional goal.

Languages

- Start with your strongest language.
- Specify your proficiency level (native, fluent or basic) and provide details (e.g. 10 years in Germany).

Computer Skills

- Software programs you know how to use.

Other Information

- Any other information that is relevant to the position or illustrates an aspect of your personality (e.g. involvement in nonprofit organizations).

Typical CV Template

First-Name LAST-NAME
E-Mail
Mobile phone
Nationality

Favor a generic job title **TITLE + years of experience** *Total nb of years of experience*

CAREER PROFILE

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Detail your strengths, technical skills and all the elements that will differentiate yourself from others

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES

Company 1

Position 1 - Country - Start-End Date
Summary of the experience
Key achievements:
-
-

Position 2 - Country - Start-End Date
Summary of the experience
Key achievements:
-
-

For your current company, detail all the positions you have occupied starting by the most recent one.

For each position, specify useful information (job title, country, start & end dates) and make a clear summary including the main achievements.

Do not use Total acronyms, jargon

Company 2

Position 1- Country - Start-End Date
Summary of the experience
Key achievements:
-
-

For your previous company, do the same

EDUCATION

"Degree eg:PhD, MSc, BSc"	Date	University
"Degree"	Date	University

List your most important Diploma, starting by the last one

RELEVANT SKILLS

-
-

- *Proficiency in IT software*
- *Mastering foreign languages*

MISCELLANEOUS

-
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Write about your interests and activities (hobbies, association / occupational group, ...)

Thank You